

The Cost Of Freedom



No one gets away with anything. Even freedom has a cost.

The smallest form of government began with man, woman, offspring, and cattle. The leader of this government was the man. For centuries, man governed over women. A woman's role was to bear and raise children, to continue the man's legacy. She was property. She had no rights. She was silenced. She had no choice.

Then one day, after centuries of having no free will, she decided: enough is enough. I want to live.

Evolution shows us that out of necessity comes the will to survive. The force that pushes a living thing beyond its ceiling, to make a change that alters the history of the world. The very first of each species that attempts the opposite of its nature risks the life it is trying to save. The first waterborne creature that touched the surface of land felt, for a moment, the freedom. Saw the beauty. The reward. And it was free. Then it died, because it had not yet developed the capability to withstand such freedom. And so we see the cost. Those that watched had a choice: some were justified in staying in the water, and some were inspired. The inspired followed, each learning from the one before, each learning to adapt and deal with the cost. Eventually, the first reptile evolved

on earth. Human beings are no different. As creatures of this earth, we are subject to the forces of evolution.

The women's fight for freedom has been a long one. For each woman who died, many were freed. Now, in 2026, we have a generation of women so free they have unlocked the shackles of their ancestors and shown that the former government led by men is no longer a necessity. It is a choice. For the first time in history, women are free.

Now what?

The man.

The first human being on earth, whom God made in his image. Before man existed, God made the heavens and the earth, light and dark, and everything on the planet. A perfect environment for man to succeed. So perfect that man grew bored and needed a companion. And so, according to the Christian Bible, God made woman from his rib.

For centuries, men ruled the earth, building structures and forming institutions to serve their vision. A continuation of Eden. Man's primary goal was to conquer, or to be conquered by other men. Even the conquered had a place: yield to the most powerful man, serve within his structure, and you belonged. This is not to diminish the lives lost to war, nor the extraordinary progress men achieved in building the world we inhabit. From the Persians and Greeks to the Egyptians and the Roman Empire, the height of civilisation. We still look back at these eras in astonishment at the sheer genius of it all.

But as man succeeded throughout history, largely unchallenged in his immediate environment, woman was silently evolving in the suffering. Quietly bearing the cost of his success.

For every empire conquered, women were traded from one man to the next. She had to adapt. She had to bear as many children as the man desired. She had to learn to endure unfathomable pain, continuously. Her life was at risk at all times and so she developed survival strategies that we are only now beginning to fully see.

We live in a world of opposites. What goes up must come down. With every great leap forward comes a proportional cost. Everything has a price.

Like a tree planted in a perfect environment, man grew tall. Strong, largely undamaged, save for a few broken branches. Woman, planted in soil not made for her, in an environment of strong winds and relentless storms, all forces

seemingly designed to break her, adapted. While man stood tall and bright, she grew bent and bruised, scarred by what she survived.

Until the environment changed.

The tall tree, having never learned to bend, breaks. The scarred tree, having spent centuries adapting, grows taller still.

Evolution.

The lonely man epidemic is the result of many factors. A significant one is economic. The rising cost of living means men can no longer support households the way previous generations could, making many hesitant to take on that responsibility. The information age has also redistributed access to knowledge, once largely controlled by men, now available to everyone. The more women advocated for equal rights and the word spread, the greater the pressure on existing structures to change.

The real challenge emerges here: when women are no longer dependent on men for financial stability, the foundational dynamic shifts. She can provide for herself. The bearing and raising of children, once enforced, becomes a choice. The old world's family structure no longer holds in a world where women are free.

Men were not prepared for a world where women are free.

And in the same breath, women were not prepared for a world where they are free either.

The fight was so long, so hard fought, that no one stopped to ask: what happens after? No one calculated the cost of the freedom they were fighting for. No one could have predicted the role social media would play in reshaping what women believe they deserve, what men believe is expected of them, and how both perform their positions for an audience rather than live them in private.

And so here we are. Women are angry. They have adapted, evolved, built careers, created lives and arrived at their late twenties and thirties ready for love, only to find the landscape has shifted beneath them. The little girl who was told: get your education first, build your career, become stable and then love will find you. She did everything right. But where are the men?

Women are angry at men for not evolving with them.

But there is more to the story.

What if freedom is not for all?